

Cloudora SOC Alert Triage & Incident Management

Simulated Client Engagement | SOC Alert Triage | ServiceNow

This portfolio artifact documents a simulated overnight SOC engagement for Cloudora, a fictional B2B HR software company. Twelve mixed security alerts were investigated using an evidence-based triage process and documented through ServiceNow.

Shift outcome

- 2 confirmed true positives
- 1 multi-site anomaly escalated according to the escalation SOP
- 7 false positives with root-cause justifications
- 1 duplicate identified and cross-referenced
- 1 alert held pending additional evidence
- 12/12 alerts investigated and dispositioned

Triage approach

Understand the detection → form hypotheses in both directions → check operational context → pivot into raw evidence → baseline the affected entity → determine verdict → assess severity from impact and confidence → document the decision and response.

Artifact contents

ServiceNow workflow evidence followed by the twelve completed triage worksheets. The original worksheet pages are preserved as submitted so the investigation trail remains traceable and defensible.

ServiceNow & Investigation Evidence

CLD-0101 / INC0010001 — Incident creation and alert details

servicenow

AllFavoritesHistoryWorkspaces

Incident - INC0010001

Search

Incident INC0010001

DiscussFollowUpdateResolveDeleteResponses

NumberINC0010001

Channel-- None --

* Caller

StateNew

CategoryInquiry / Help

Impact3 - Low

Subcategory-- None --

Urgency3 - Low

Service

Priority4 - Low

Service offering

Assignment group

Configuration item

Assigned to

* Short descriptionCLD-0101 | Multiple failed sign-ins: svc-backup@cloudora.io

DescriptionRule "Repeated authentication failures (service account)" fired. 18 failed sign-ins (error 50126, invalid credentials) for svc-backup@cloudora.io between 23:41 and 00:03 UTC, source 203.0.113.20 (LDN-SRV-BK1, internal backup server), followed by a successful sign-in at 00:14 UTC from the same host. Evidence: evidence/cloudora_signin_slice.csv.

Related Search Results

NotesRelated RecordsResolution Information

Watch listWork notes list

Work notesWork notes

Comments (Customer visible)Post

CLD-0101 / INC0010001 — Work notes and resolution

Incident INC0010001

DiscussFollowUpdateCloseReopenDeleteResponses

Activities: 4

System Administrator

Field changes • 2026-08-26 13:47:05

Incident stateResolved was New

Resolution codeSolution provided

Resolution notesFalse positive, expected maintenance activity. 18 authentication failures (50126) from 203.0.113.20 (LDN-SRV-BK1) occurred during approved credential rotation CHG-2088 and resolved with a successful sign-in at 00:14. Reported High re-rated to Informational. No external source activity identified. Close with reference to CHG-2088. Recommend suppressing service-account failures during approved change windows.

System Administrator

Work notes • 2026-08-26 13:28:38

False positive, expected maintenance activity 18 failures error 50126 from 203.0.113.20 (LDN-SRV-BK1, the account's internal backup server) evenly spaced, resolving to a clean success at 00:14 as change CHG-2088 completed. Reported High re-rated to informational: pre-announced nothing external touched the account, Action close reference CHG-2088 Tuning suppress service account failures inside an approved change window.

System Administrator

Work notes • 2026-08-26 13:28:22

False positive, expected maintenance activity 18 failures error 50126 from 203.0.113.20 (LDN-SRV-BK1, the account's internal backup server) evenly spaced, resolving to a clean success at 00:14 as change CHG-2088 completed. Reported High re-rated to informational: pre-announced nothing external touched the account, Action close reference CHG-2088 Tuning suppress service account failures inside an approved change window.

System Administrator

Field changes • 2026-08-25 10:11:41

Impact3 - Low

Incident stateNew

Opened bySystem Administrator

Priority4 - Low

ServiceNow & Investigation Evidence

CLD-0102 / INC0010002 — Active malware incident

Incident - INC0010002

Search

Incident - INC0010002

Discuss Follow Update Resolve Delete Responses

Number INC0010002

Channel -- None --

* Caller System Administrator

State In Progress

Category Inquiry / Help

Impact 2 - Medium

Subcategory -- None --

Urgency 1 - High

Service

Priority 2 - High

Service offering

Assignment group

Configuration item

Assigned to

* Short description CLD-0102 | Malware detected, quarantine failed: LDN-WS-117

Description Rule 'Active threat not remediated' fired. Detection Trojan:Win32/Stealgen.B (credential stealer) on LDN-WS-117 (assigned user liam.doyle). Four detection events between 02:13 and 02:41 UTC; quarantine FAILED each time and the file reappears at C:\Users\liam.doyle\AppData\Roaming\WinSyncSvc\wsync.exe. Evidence: evidence/cloudora_av_detections.log.

Related Search Results

Notes Related Records Resolution Information

Watch list

Work notes list

Work notes True positive, active credential stealer on LDN-WS-117 (liam.doyle); remediation failing. AV log shows clean scan 30 Aug followed by four detections between 02:13 and 02:41 on 1 Sep. Quarantine failed with escalating reasons and a second file (wsync_upd.exe) appeared. Verdict: active malware with persistence behaviour. Action: isolate LDN-WS-117 from the network, raise incident for eradication/reimage, force password reset and session revocation for liam.doyle as a precaution, and monitor for anomalous sign-ins. Evidence: evidence/cloudora_av_detections.log

CLD-0103 / INC0010003 — Authorized scanner false positive

Incident - INC0010003

Search

Incident - INC0010003

Discuss Follow Update Resolve Delete Responses

Number INC0010003

Channel -- None --

* Caller System Administrator

State Resolved

Category Inquiry / Help

Impact 3 - Low

Subcategory -- None --

Urgency 3 - Low

Service

Priority 4 - Low

Service offering

Assignment group

Configuration item

Assigned to

* Short description CLD-0103 | Internal port scan detected from 203.0.113.44

Description Rule 'TCP port sweep' fired. Host 203.0.113.44 (LDN-SCAN-01) probed 4,000+ TCP ports across 180 internal hosts between 22:10 and 02:5x UTC. Traffic pattern: sequential SYN probes, no data transfer. No other alerts from this source.

Related Search Results

Notes Related Records Resolution Information

Watch list

Work notes list

Work notes False positive, authorised scanner activity. Source 203.0.113.44 (LDN-SCAN-01) matches the documented weekly vulnerability sweep Monday 22:00-Tuesday 03:00. Alert occurred within the approved window. Sequential SYN probes across the estate with no data transfer and no follow-on alerts are consistent with scanner behaviour. Closing with reference to the authorised scan schedule. Recommend a tuning change via change control to suppress the port-sweep rule for LDN-SCAN-01 during its approved window; do not disable the rule globally.

ServiceNow & Investigation Evidence

CLD-0104 / INC0010004 — MFA re-enrollment false positive

Incident
INC0010004

DiscussFollowUpdateResolveDeleteResponses

NumberINC0010004

Channel-- None --

* CallerSystem Administrator

StateResolved

CategoryInquiry / Help

Impact3 - Low

Subcategory-- None --

Urgency3 - Low

Service

Priority4 - Low

Service offering

Assignment group

Configuration item

Assigned to

* Short descriptionCLD-0104 | Repeated MFA failures then success: nina.cole@cloudora.io

DescriptionRule 'MFA failures followed by success' fired. Five MFA denials (error 500121) for nina.cole@cloudora.io between 06:31 and 06:47 UTC, then a successful sign-in at 06:52 UTC. All events from 198.51.100.22 (Manchester office), Windows 10, Chrome. A new authenticator device was registered at 06:50 UTC. Evidence: evidence/cloudora_signin_slice.csv. Related: helpdesk ticket HD-4471 raised at 07:05 UTC.

Related Search Results >

NotesRelated RecordsResolution Information

Watch listWork notes list

Work notesFalse positive, user error during phone replacement. Evidence checked: sign-in slice shows five MFA denials from 06:31 to 06:47 followed by a successful sign-in at 06:52, all from Nina Cole's usual Manchester office IP and known Windows 10/Chrome device. Helpdesk ticket HD-4471 was raised by Nina at 07:05 requesting help re-enrolling MFA on a new phone, matching the timeline. New authenticator registration at 06:50 is consistent with legitimate self-enrollment. Verdict: false positive, user error during phone replacement. Severity re-rated to Informational. No password reset required. Close referencing HD-4471. Recommend auto-annotating MFA re-enrollment events when a matching helpdesk ticket exists.

CLD-0105 / INC0010005 — Email investigation

Incident
INC0010005

DiscussFollowUpdateResolveDeleteResponses

NumberINC0010005

Channel-- None --

* CallerSystem Administrator

StateResolved

CategoryInquiry / Help

Impact3 - Low

Subcategory-- None --

Urgency3 - Low

Service

Priority4 - Low

Service offering

Assignment group

Configuration item

Assigned to

* Short descriptionCLD-0105 | User-reported suspicious email: 'Your August payslip is ready'

Descriptionjames.holt@cloudora.io reported an email received at 07:45 UTC, sender shown as payroll@cloudora.io, subject 'Your August payslip is ready', containing a link to a payslip portal. Reporter note: 'After last week I am not clicking anything from payroll. Please check.' Per post-CLD-0002 policy every user report is triaged. Evidence: evidence/emails/01_reported_payslip_notification.eml.

Related Search Results >

NotesRelated RecordsResolution Information

Watch listWork notes list

Work notesFalse positive, legitimate internal payroll notification. Evidence checked: raw email headers show the From domain is cloudora.io with SPF, DKIM and DMARC all passing and aligned to cloudora.io. The Received chain shows the message originated internally from myhr-notify.cloudora.io (203.0.113.8) and did not leave Cloudora infrastructure. Email body links only to the legitimate myhr.cloudora.io portal and contains no credential, payment or other suspicious request. Verdict: legitimate internal mail. Severity re-rated to Informational. Action: close the alert, reply to the reporter thanking him for reporting it, confirm the email is genuine, and encourage continued reporting.

ServiceNow & Investigation Evidence

CLD-0106 / INC0010006 — Duplicate incident

Incident
INC0010006

DiscussFollowUpdateResolveDeleteResponses

NumberINC0010006

* CallerSystem Administrator

CategoryInquiry / Help

Subcategory-- None --

Service

Service offering

Configuration item

Channel-- None --

StateResolved

Impact3 - Low

Urgency3 - Low

Priority4 - Low

Assignment group

Assigned to

* Short descriptionCLD-0106 | Daily summary: 1 device with active unresolved threats

DescriptionAutomated ticket from the Defender daily email digest (08:00 UTC summary): 1 device with active unresolved threats in the last 24 hours: LDN-WS-117, detection Trojan:Win32/Stealgen.B, remediation incomplete. Evidence: evidence/cloudora_av_detections.log.

Related Search Results >

NotesRelated RecordsResolution Information

Knowledge

* Resolution codeDuplicate

* Resolution notesDuplicate of CLD-0102. Evidence checked: Defender AV daily digest at 08:00 summarises the same LDN-WS-117 Trojan:Win32/Stealgen.B detections already handled under CLD-0102. No new host, detection, indicator, or time window identified. Action: close as duplicate and cross-reference CLD-0102. Recommend correlating the Defender digest connector with real-time alerts to prevent duplicate tickets and preserve a single evidence trail.

Resolved by

Resolved

CLD-0107 / INC0010007 — HR retention automation

servicenow

AllFavoritesHistoryWorkspaces

Incident - INC0010007

Search

DiscussFollowUpdateResolveDeleteResponses

* CallerSystem Administrator

CategoryInquiry / Help

Subcategory-- None --

Service

Service offering

Configuration item

StateResolved

Impact3 - Low

Urgency3 - Low

Priority4 - Low

Assignment group

Assigned to

* Short descriptionCLD-0107 | Mass file deletion: 1,240 files removed from SharePoint

DescriptionRule 'Mass deletion by a single user' fired (cloud activity alerts can lag the activity by several hours). 1,240 files deleted from SharePoint site 'HR-Records-Archive', folder 'Leavers-2019', between 03:00 and 03:20 UTC under the account tara.kemp@cloudora.io. Activity detail records the initiating process as 'HR-RetentionFlow' (scheduled automation).

Related Search Results >

NotesRelated RecordsResolution Information

Knowledge

* Resolution codeSolution provided

* Resolution notesFalse positive, authorised HR records-retention cleanup. Evidence checked: the handover confirms HR-RetentionFlow is executing this week under Tara Kemp's account during the early hours to delete expired records from the HR archive under the seven-year retention policy. The 1,240 deletions occurred in HR-Records-Archive at 03:00 and match the expected retention activity and initiating process. Verdict: authorised automation, not compromised-account or ransomware activity. Reported High re-rated to Informational. Action: close with reference to the retention schedule and recommend tuning the mass-deletion rule to recognise HR-RetentionFlow operating on HR-Records-Archive during its approved retention window, while continuing to alert on mass deletion outside that process, folder or window.

Resolved by

Resolved

ServiceNow & Investigation Evidence

CLD-0108 / INC0010008 — Probable credential compromise

servicenow

AllFavoritesHistoryWorkspaces

Incident - INC0010008

Search

Incident INC0010008

DiscussFollowUpdateResolveDeleteResponses

NumberINC0010008

Channel-- None --

* CallerSystem Administrator

StateIn Progress

CategoryInquiry / Help

Impact2 - Medium

Subcategory-- None --

Urgency1 - High

Service

Priority2 - High

Service offering

Assignment group

Configuration item

Assigned to

* Short descriptionCLD-0108 | First-time sign-in properties: gwen.muir@cloudora.io

DescriptionRule 'Unfamiliar sign-in properties' fired (risk detections are batch-evaluated and can lag). One successful sign-in for gwen.muir@cloudora.io at 03:54 UTC from 198.18.163.41 (geolocates to London, United Kingdom; residential provider), client app IMAP4 (legacy protocol), Windows 10, Firefox. No failed attempts preceded it. Evidence: evidence/cloudora_signin_slice.csv.

Related Search Results

Notes

Related Records

Resolution Information

Watch list

Work notes list

* Work notes

Probable credential compromise. Investigation established Gwen Muir's historical baseline using sign-in logs and KQ analysis. The 03:54 UTC successful authentication deviated from the user's normal behaviour in IP address, login time, browser, device and client application, using Windows 10, Firefox and legacy IMAP4. No failed attempts preceded the successful authentication, suggesting the password may already have been obtained rather than guessed. No follow-on audit activity was identified at this stage. Verdict: probable credential compromise. Reported Low re-rated to Sev 2. Action: account escalated to the Identity and Access Management team for immediate containment, session/token revocation, password reset, investigation of IMAP4 usage and mailbox activity, and disabling legacy IMAP4 authentication. Further authentication, mailbox and sign-in activity should be reviewed to determine how the credential was obtained

CLD-0109 / INC0010009 — Multi-site beaconing escalation

servicenow

AllFavoritesHistoryWorkspaces

Incident - INC0010009

Search

Incident INC0010009

DiscussFollowUpdateResolveDeleteResponses

NumberINC0010009

Channel-- None --

* CallerSystem Administrator

StateIn Progress

CategoryInquiry / Help

Impact2 - Medium

Subcategory-- None --

Urgency2 - Medium

Service

Priority3 - Moderate

Service offering

Assignment group

Configuration item

Assigned to

* Short descriptionCLD-0109 | Repeated outbound connections to rare external host (3 hosts)

DescriptionRule 'Periodic outbound connections to uncategorised destination' fired. Since approximately 07:40 UTC, three internal hosts: LDN-WS-104 (aria.reid), MAN-LT-033 (finn.gale) and AUS-WS-208 (dean.page), have each made an outbound HTTPS connection to 198.18.207.66 roughly every 60 seconds. The destination is uncategorised by the firewall threat feed and its domain registration is 9 days old. Hosts are in three different offices (London, Manchester, Austin).

Related Search Results

Notes

Related Records

Resolution Information

Watch list

Work notes list

* Work notes

Malicious beaconing across three offices. Evidence checked: LDN-WS-104, MAN-LT-033 and AUS-WS-208 each connected to the same nine-day-old external host every 60 seconds since 07:40, indicating a possible beaconing pattern. Sign-in activity for the three assigned users showed no anomalous authentication activity. Verdict: escalate for further investigation; activity cannot be safely closed or resolved at triage. Reported Medium retained as interim severity. Action: escalate to the vCISO with the affected hosts, destination host, connection interval, start time and supporting network/endpoint evidence. Containment of the three hosts is deferred pending the appropriate incident-response decision.

Screenshots are included as portfolio evidence of the simulated ServiceNow workflow.

ServiceNow & Investigation Evidence

CLD-0111 / INC0010011 — Insufficient-data investigation

servicenow

AllFavoritesHistoryWorkspaces

Incident - INC0010011

Search

Incident INC0010011

DiscussFollowUpdateResolveDeleteResponses

NumberINC0010011

Channel-- None --

* CallerSystem Administrator

StateIn Progress

CategoryInquiry / Help

Impact2 - Medium

Subcategory-- None --

Urgency2 - Medium

Service

Priority3 - Moderate

Service offering

Assignment group

Configuration item

Assigned to

* Short descriptionCLD-0111 | User-reported suspicious email: 'Overdue invoice INV-2214'

Descriptionlucas.ford@cloudora.io (accounts payable) reported an email received at 08:19 UTC from billing@meridianoffice.example ('Meridian Office Supplies Ltd'), subject 'Overdue invoice INV-2214, second reminder', with attachment INV-2214.pdf. Reporter note: 'Not sure we use this supplier. Have not opened the attachment. Or I do not think I did.' Evidence: evidence/emails/02_reported_supplier_invoice.eml.

Related Search Results

NotesRelated RecordsResolution Information

Watch listWork notes list

* Work notesInsufficient data, reported supplier invoice requires further verification. Evidence checked: email headers show SPF pass, but DKIM and DMARC are absent, which does not establish that the message is either legitimate or malicious. The sender/domain, supplier relationship, attachment contents, recipient scope and whether the attachment was opened cannot currently be confirmed from the available evidence. Verdict: insufficient data; neither phishing nor legitimate mail is defensible at this stage. Action: verify Meridian Office Supplies with Accounts Payable/procurement, safely detonate or scan the PDF in the approved malware-analysis/sandbox tool, search mail logs/message trace to identify other recipients, and check endpoint/application telemetry to determine whether Lucas Ford opened or executed the attachment. Keep the ticket open pending evidence. Interim severity: Medium. Escalate immediately if Lucas confirms he opened the attachment or if endpoint evidence shows the PDF was opened/executed or any suspicious activity followed.

CLD-0110 / INC0010010 — Blocked malicious authentication

servicenow

AllFavoritesHistoryWorkspaces

Incident - INC0010010

Search

Incident INC0010010

DiscussFollowUpdateResolveDeleteResponses

NumberINC0010010

Channel-- None --

* CallerSystem Administrator

StateResolved

CategoryInquiry / Help

Impact3 - Low

Subcategory-- None --

Urgency3 - Low

Service

Priority4 - Low

Service offering

Assignment group

Configuration item

Assigned to

* Short descriptionCLD-0110 | Blocked sign-in attempts from watchlist IP: daniel.reeve@cloudora.io

DescriptionScheduled analytic 'Watchlist IP activity' fired (runs every few hours). Three sign-in attempts for daniel.reeve@cloudora.io between 05:09 and 05:11 UTC from 102.89.44.17 (Lagos, Nigeria), all returned error 53003, blocked by Conditional Access policy. This IP is on the tenant block list: it is attacker infrastructure from incident CLD-0001 (August executive account takeover). Evidence: evidence/cloudora_signin_slice.csv.

Related Search Results

NotesRelated RecordsResolution Information

Knowledge

* Resolution codeSolution provided

* Resolution notesTrue positive, blocked attacker activity. Evidence checked: three sign-in attempts for daniel.reeve from 102.89.44.17, a known CLD-0001 attacker infrastructure IP, all returned error 53003 and were blocked by Conditional Access. No successful sign-in from 102.89.x was identified in the slice, and the CEO's normal morning activity remained unaffected. Verdict: true positive, blocked attack with no confirmed account impact. Reported Low retained per the severity matrix because the control prevented successful access. Action: continue monitoring the watchlist IP and re-raise severity if any sign-in from 102.89.x succeeds or Conditional Access no longer blocks activity. Add the attempted activity and confirmed block to the CLD-0001 record as evidence of infrastructure reuse.

Resolved by

Resolved

ServiceNow & Investigation Evidence

CLD-0112 / INC0010012 — Impossible-travel false positive

servicenow

AllFavoritesHistoryWorkspaces

Incident - INC0010012

Search

Incident INC0010012

DiscussFollowUpdateResolveDeleteResponses

* CallerSystem Administrator

CategoryInquiry / Help

Subcategory-- None --

Service

Service offering

Configuration item

StateResolved

Impact3 - Low

Urgency3 - Low

Priority4 - Low

Assignment group

Assigned to

* Short descriptionCLD-0112 | Impossible travel: omar.farah@cloudora.io (Dubai then London)

DescriptionRule 'Atypical travel' fired (this detection is ML-based and lags by design). omar.farah@cloudora.io signed in from Dubai, United Arab Emirates at 05:58 UTC and from London, United Kingdom (203.0.113.10) at 06:40 UTC, 42 minutes apart. The two locations are roughly a seven hour flight apart. Evidence: evidence/cloudora_signin_slice.csv.

Related Search Results

NotesRelated RecordsResolution Information

Knowledge

* Resolution codeSolution provided

* Resolution notesFalse positive, legitimate travel with non-interactive office desktop activity. Evidence checked: Omar Farah's sign-in slice shows the Dubai event at 05:58 as the genuine interactive user activity while the London event at 06:40 is a non-interactive token refresh from his docked office desktop. The London event therefore represents a machine at a fixed desk refreshing a token rather than Omar physically signing in from London. Omar's documented Dubai travel history in CLD-0001 supports the travel context. Verdict: false positive, legitimate travel with expected non-interactive desktop activity. Reported Medium re-rated to Informational. Action: close with reference to the documented travel context and recommend a low-cost travel-notification hygiene improvement so expected travel can be identified during triage. Justification: the misleading event is the London non-interactive token refresh, while the Dubai event is the interactive human activity. A true positive would have been indicated by an interactive London sign-in while Omar was in Dubai or a different device/application pattern inconsistent with his

Resolved by

Resolved

Azure Data Explorer — Identity baseline query for CLD-0108

Azure Data Explorer

Query

Cloudora.MyDatab...

Run

Cloudora/MyDatabase

1 nInSlice.Cl

2 rPrincipalName == "gwen.muir@cloudora.io"

3 SignIns=count(), FirstSeen=min(TimeGenerated), LastSeen=max(TimeGenerated) by AppDisplayName, Country, City, DeviceOS

4 SignIns desc

Table 1

Search2026-08-31 01:40 (UTC)# 4Hide empty columns

AppDisplayName	Country	City	DeviceOS	SignIns	FirstSeen	LastSeen
> Microsoft 365	United Kingdom	London	macOS 14	2	8/31/2026, 8:26:38 AM	9/1/2026, 8:31:12 AM
> SharePoint Online	United Kingdom	London	macOS 14	1	8/31/2026, 1:44:01 PM	8/31/2026, 1:44:01 PM
> Outlook Web App	United Kingdom	London	macOS 14	1	8/31/2026, 4:09:35 PM	8/31/2026, 4:09:35 PM
> IMAP4 (legacy protocol)	United Kingdom	London	Windows 10	1	9/1/2026, 3:54:37 AM	9/1/2026, 3:54:37 AM

End-of-Shift Summary

Alert	Disposition	Severity
CLD-0101	False positive — approved backup credential rotation (CHG-2088	Informational
CLD-0102	True positive — active credential stealer on LDN-WS-117	Sev 2
CLD-0103	False positive — authorized vulnerability scanner	Informational
CLD-0104	False positive — legitimate MFA re-enrollment	Informational
CLD-0105	False positive — legitimate internal payroll notification	Informational
CLD-0106	Duplicate — same underlying event as CLD-0102	N/A
CLD-0107	False positive — authorized HR retention automation	Informational
CLD-0108	True positive — probable credential compromise	Sev 2
CLD-0109	Escalate — multi-site periodic outbound beaconing	Sev 2 interim
CLD-0110	True positive activity, blocked before access	Low
CLD-0111	Insufficient data — evidence collection required	Medium interim
CLD-0112	False positive — travel plus non-interactive token refresh	Informational

Key portfolio takeaway

The exercise demonstrates an end-to-end SOC workflow: alert interpretation, contextual validation, evidence-based investigation, severity assessment, ServiceNow documentation, escalation, closure, duplicate handling, and detection-tuning recommendations.

Triage Verdict

Seven parts, one paragraph of thinking. Test: could another analyst retrace your steps from this page alone?

ALERT ID

CLD-0101

SOURCE SYSTEM

Identity Monitoring Entra ID

ALERT TIME (UTC)

31 Aug 23:41 UTC

ANALYST**ALERT (WHAT FIRED, ON WHOM OR WHAT)**

18 failed sign-ins for svc-backup@cloudora.io from 203.0.113.20 (LDN-SRV-BK1), followed by a successful sign-in at 00:14.

HYPOTHESIS (BOTH DIRECTIONS)

Possible malicious brute-force activity against the service account OR expected authentication failures caused by the scheduled backup credential rotation.

EVIDENCE CHECKED (NAME THE ACTUAL SOURCES AND WHAT EACH SHOWED)

Shift handover: CHG-2088 scheduled backup credential rotation from 23:00 to 02:30 UTC and warned of expected authentication failures. Cloudora sign-in slice: 18 invalid credential failures from LDN-SRV-BK1 between 23:41 and 00:03, followed by a successful login at 00:14.

VERDICT (TICK ONE)

☐ True positive ☒ False positive ☐ Duplicate ☐ Escalate ☐ Insufficient data

SEVERITY YOU ASSIGNED (TICK ONE)

☐ Sev 1 ☐ Sev 2 ☐ Sev 3 ☐ Sev 4 ☒ Informational

REPORTED SEVERITY, AND WHY RE-RATED

Reported severity was high. Re-rated to Informational because the authentication failures occurred

ACTION (CLOSE / MONITOR UNTIL / ESCALATE TO / GATHER WHAT)

Close the alert and reference CHG-2088. Recommend tuning the detection rule to suppress expected service-account authentication failures during approved credential rotation windows.

JUSTIFICATION (THE SENTENCE THAT MAKES IT DEFENSIBLE)

The source host, service account, timing, authentication failure pattern, and subsequent successful login all match the approved credential rotation activity. No external or anomalous source was identified.

MITRE ATT&CK (TRUE POSITIVES AND ESCALATIONS ONLY; A FALSE POSITIVE GETS NO TECHNIQUE)

Triage Verdict

Seven parts, one paragraph of thinking. Test: could another analyst retrace your steps from this page alone?

ALERT ID

CLD-0102

SOURCE SYSTEM

Endpoint Protection (defender)

ALERT TIME (UTC)

1 Sep 02:45 UTC

ANALYST**ALERT (WHAT FIRED, ON WHOM OR WHAT)**

CLD-0102 detected Trojan:Win32/Stealgen.B, a credential-stealing malware, four times on LDN-WS-117 associated with liam.doyle. Quarantine failed on each detection and the malware activity continued with an additional file appearing.

HYPOTHESIS (BOTH DIRECTIONS)

Active malware infection with persistence behavior versus a false positive or stale detection from a previously remediated file.

EVIDENCE CHECKED (NAME THE ACTUAL SOURCES AND WHAT EACH SHOWED)

Cloudora AV detection log showed a clean scheduled scan on 30 Aug followed by four detections between 02:13 and 02:41 on 1 Sep. Quarantine failed repeatedly with different failure reasons, and a second file, wsync_upd.exe, appeared in the same hidden folder. The shift handover contained no authorized change explaining the activity. The sign-in slice showed liam.doyle's morning sign-in as normal and no evidence of anomalous sign-ins.

VERDICT (TICK ONE)

☒ True positive ☐ False positive ☐ Duplicate ☐ Escalate ☐ Insufficient data

SEVERITY YOU ASSIGNED (TICK ONE)

☐ Sev 1 ☒ Sev 2 ☐ Sev 3 ☐ Sev 4 ☐ Informational

REPORTED SEVERITY, AND WHY RE-RATED

Reported severity was High. Re-rated to Sev 2 because the malware activity is confirmed and involves a credential stealer with potential account compromise impact, but the currently confirmed scope is limited to one host and one user.

ACTION (CLOSE / MONITOR UNTIL / ESCALATE TO / GATHER WHAT)

Isolate LDN-WS-117 from the network, escalate to IT/security response for eradication and reimaging, reset liam.doyle's password, revoke active sessions, and monitor the account for anomalous sign-ins.

JUSTIFICATION (THE SENTENCE THAT MAKES IT DEFENSIBLE)

Repeated failed quarantine attempts combined with continued file generation and the appearance of a second executable confirm active malware behavior rather than a stale or false detection. Because the malware is a credential stealer, credentials used on the infected host must be treated as potentially compromised.

MITRE ATT&CK (TRUE POSITIVES AND ESCALATIONS ONLY; A FALSE POSITIVE GETS NO TECHNIQUE)

T1204.002 – User Execution: Malicious file

Triage Verdict

Seven parts, one paragraph of thinking. Test: could another analyst retrace your steps from this page alone?

ALERT ID

CLD-0103

SOURCE SYSTEM

Perimeter Firewall / IDS

ALERT TIME (UTC)

1 Sep 02:52 UTC

ANALYST**ALERT (WHAT FIRED, ON WHOM OR WHAT)**

CLD-0103 detected an internal port sweep from 203.0.113.44, probing more than 4,000 TCP ports across approximately 180 internal hosts overnight.

HYPOTHESIS (BOTH DIRECTIONS)

Possible malicious internal reconnaissance versus authorized vulnerability scanning activity from the organization's scheduled scanner.

EVIDENCE CHECKED (NAME THE ACTUAL SOURCES AND WHAT EACH SHOWED)

Shift handover confirmed that LDN-SCAN-01 at 203.0.113.44 performs an authorized weekly vulnerability scan from Monday 22:00 to Tuesday 03:00 UTC. Alert details showed sequential SYN probes across the environment with no data transfer and no follow-on suspicious activity.

VERDICT (TICK ONE)

☐ True positive ☒ False positive ☐ Duplicate ☐ Escalate ☐ Insufficient data

SEVERITY YOU ASSIGNED (TICK ONE)

☐ Sev 1 ☐ Sev 2 ☐ Sev 3 ☐ Sev 4 ☒ Informational

REPORTED SEVERITY, AND WHY RE-RATED

Reported severity was Medium. Re-rated to Informational because the source IP, timing, scope, and traffic pattern exactly match the documented and authorized vulnerability scanning activity.

ACTION (CLOSE / MONITOR UNTIL / ESCALATE TO / GATHER WHAT)

Close the alert and reference the authorized scanning schedule. Recommend tuning the detection rule to suppress alerts specifically for LDN-SCAN-01 during its approved scanning window.

JUSTIFICATION (THE SENTENCE THAT MAKES IT DEFENSIBLE)

The source IP, scheduled time, scanning scope, and sequential SYN probe pattern all match the documented weekly vulnerability scan. No data transfer or follow-on suspicious activity was observed.

MITRE ATT&CK (TRUE POSITIVES AND ESCALATIONS ONLY; A FALSE POSITIVE GETS NO TECHNIQUE)

Triage Verdict

Seven parts, one paragraph of thinking. Test: could another analyst retrace your steps from this page alone?

ALERT ID

CLD-0104

SOURCE SYSTEM

Identity Monitoring (Entra ID)

ALERT TIME (UTC)

1 Sep 06:55 UTC

ANALYST**ALERT (WHAT FIRED, ON WHOM OR WHAT)**

CLD-0104 detected five MFA denials for nina.cole between 06:31 and 06:47, followed by a new authenticator registration at 06:50 and a successful sign-in at 06:52.

HYPOTHESIS (BOTH DIRECTIONS)

MFA fatigue attack with unauthorized authenticator registration versus legitimate user MFA re-enrollment due to a new phone.

EVIDENCE CHECKED (NAME THE ACTUAL SOURCES AND WHAT EACH SHOWED)

Cloudora sign-in slice showed all MFA events and the successful sign-in originated from nina.cole's usual Manchester office IP, Windows 10 device, and Chrome browser. Helpdesk ticket HD-4471 confirmed that Nina contacted support regarding MFA re-enrollment on a new phone. The new authenticator registration occurred immediately before the successful sign-in.

VERDICT (TICK ONE)

☐ True positive ☒ False positive ☐ Duplicate ☐ Escalate ☐ Insufficient data

SEVERITY YOU ASSIGNED (TICK ONE)

☐ Sev 1 ☐ Sev 2 ☐ Sev 3 ☐ Sev 4 ☒ Informational

REPORTED SEVERITY, AND WHY RE-RATED

Reported severity was Medium. Re-rated to Informational because all activity originated from the user's known location and device, and the matching helpdesk ticket confirmed legitimate MFA re-enrollment on a new phone.

ACTION (CLOSE / MONITOR UNTIL / ESCALATE TO / GATHER WHAT)

Close the alert and reference HD-4471. No password reset is required. Recommend correlating MFA re-enrollment alerts with matching helpdesk tickets to reduce unnecessary alerts.

JUSTIFICATION (THE SENTENCE THAT MAKES IT DEFENSIBLE)

The activity pattern, known device and location, and matching user-initiated helpdesk ticket all support legitimate MFA re-enrollment. No evidence of an external or unknown device was identified

MITRE ATT&CK (TRUE POSITIVES AND ESCALATIONS ONLY; A FALSE POSITIVE GETS NO TECHNIQUE)

Triage Verdict

Seven parts, one paragraph of thinking. Test: could another analyst retrace your steps from this page alone?

ALERT ID

CLD-0105

SOURCE SYSTEM

User report to soc@cloudora.io

ALERT TIME (UTC)

1 Sep 07:58 UTC

ANALYST**ALERT (WHAT FIRED, ON WHOM OR WHAT)**

CLD-0105 involved a user-reported payroll email titled "Your August payslip is ready," reported by james.holt due to concerns following the previous payroll phishing campaign.

HYPOTHESIS (BOTH DIRECTIONS)

A new payroll-themed phishing campaign versus a legitimate internal monthly payslip notification.

EVIDENCE CHECKED (NAME THE ACTUAL SOURCES AND WHAT EACH SHOWED)

Raw email headers showed the sender as payroll@cloudora.io. SPF, DKIM, and DMARC all passed and aligned with cloudora.io. The Received chain showed the message originated from internal infrastructure at myhr-notify.cloudora.io. The email body linked only to the legitimate myhr.cloudora.io portal and contained no credential, payment, or urgent action request

VERDICT (TICK ONE)

☐ True positive ☒ False positive ☐ Duplicate ☐ Escalate ☐ Insufficient data

SEVERITY YOU ASSIGNED (TICK ONE)

☐ Sev 1 ☐ Sev 2 ☐ Sev 3 ☐ Sev 4 ☒ Informational

REPORTED SEVERITY, AND WHY RE-RATED

Reported severity was Medium. Re-rated to Informational because email authentication aligned with the legitimate Cloudora domain, the message originated from internal infrastructure, and the content linked only to the legitimate HR portal without requesting credentials or sensitive information.

ACTION (CLOSE / MONITOR UNTIL / ESCALATE TO / GATHER WHAT)

Close the alert and reply to james.holt confirming the email was legitimate. Thank the user for reporting the message and encourage continued reporting of suspicious emails.

JUSTIFICATION (THE SENTENCE THAT MAKES IT DEFENSIBLE)

The email authentication results, internal Received chain, legitimate sender domain, and safe link destination collectively confirm the message was a legitimate internal payroll notification rather than a phishing attempt.

MITRE ATT&CK (TRUE POSITIVES AND ESCALATIONS ONLY; A FALSE POSITIVE GETS NO TECHNIQUE)

Triage Verdict

Seven parts, one paragraph of thinking. Test: could another analyst retrace your steps from this page alone?

ALERT ID

CLD-0106

SOURCE SYSTEM

Defender Daily Digest Connector

ALERT TIME (UTC)

1 Sep 08:05 UTC

ANALYST**ALERT (WHAT FIRED, ON WHOM OR WHAT)**

CLD-0106 is an automated Defender daily digest reporting an active unresolved threat, Trojan:Win32/Stealgen.B, on LDN-WS-117.

HYPOTHESIS (BOTH DIRECTIONS)

A new unresolved malware event versus a duplicate notification summarizing the active malware incident already investigated under CLD-0102.

EVIDENCE CHECKED (NAME THE ACTUAL SOURCES AND WHAT EACH SHOWED)

Cloudora AV detection log showed that the 08:00 Defender daily digest summarized the same unresolved Trojan:Win32/Stealgen.B detection on LDN-WS-117 previously investigated in CLD-0102. No new host, malware indicator, or activity was identified.

VERDICT (TICK ONE)

☐ True positive ☐ False positive ☒ Duplicate ☐ Escalate ☐ Insufficient data

SEVERITY YOU ASSIGNED (TICK ONE)

☐ Sev 1 ☐ Sev 2 ☐ Sev 3 ☐ Sev 4 ☒ Informational

REPORTED SEVERITY, AND WHY RE-RATED

Reported severity was Medium. This ticket was identified as a duplicate of CLD-0102 and does not require an independent severity rating because the original incident remains the authoritative investigation record.

ACTION (CLOSE / MONITOR UNTIL / ESCALATE TO / GATHER WHAT)

Close CLD-0106 as a duplicate and cross-reference CLD-0102. Recommend correlating or suppressing daily digest alerts when the same threat is already being tracked through a real-time incident.

JUSTIFICATION (THE SENTENCE THAT MAKES IT DEFENSIBLE)

The host, malware detection, and unresolved status are identical to CLD-0102. The daily digest introduced no new indicators or activity and represents a second alerting path for the same underlying security event.

MITRE ATT&CK (TRUE POSITIVES AND ESCALATIONS ONLY; A FALSE POSITIVE GETS NO TECHNIQUE)

Triage Verdict

Seven parts, one paragraph of thinking. Test: could another analyst retrace your steps from this page alone?

ALERT ID

CLD-0107

SOURCE SYSTEM

M365 activity alerting

ALERT TIME (UTC)

1 Sep 08:12 UTC

ANALYST**ALERT (WHAT FIRED, ON WHOM OR WHAT)**

CLD-0107 detected the deletion of 1,240 files from HR-Records-Archive under tara.kemp's account at approximately 03:00 UTC.

HYPOTHESIS (BOTH DIRECTIONS)

Mass file deletion caused by a compromised account or ransomware activity versus authorized HR records retention automation.

EVIDENCE CHECKED (NAME THE ACTUAL SOURCES AND WHAT EACH SHOWED)

The shift handover documented that HR-RetentionFlow runs under tara.kemp's account during early hours to delete expired records from the HR archive as part of the seven-year retention policy. The account, timing, deletion activity, and target location matched the documented automation.

VERDICT (TICK ONE)

☐ True positive ☒ False positive ☐ Duplicate ☐ Escalate ☐ Insufficient data

SEVERITY YOU ASSIGNED (TICK ONE)

☐ Sev 1 ☐ Sev 2 ☐ Sev 3 ☐ Sev 4 ☒ Informational

REPORTED SEVERITY, AND WHY RE-RATED

Reported severity was High. Re-rated to Informational because the mass deletion activity matched the documented and authorized HR retention automation, including the expected account, timing, process, and target archive.

ACTION (CLOSE / MONITOR UNTIL / ESCALATE TO / GATHER WHAT)

Close the alert and document the authorized HR-RetentionFlow activity. Recommend a narrowly scoped exception for the approved retention automation while continuing to monitor for unexpected mass deletion activity.

JUSTIFICATION (THE SENTENCE THAT MAKES IT DEFENSIBLE)

Although the volume of deleted files triggered the detection rule, the activity matched the documented HR records retention process. The correct account, automation, timing, and target archive support legitimate authorized activity rather than ransomware or account compromise.

MITRE ATT&CK (TRUE POSITIVES AND ESCALATIONS ONLY; A FALSE POSITIVE GETS NO TECHNIQUE)

Triage Verdict

Seven parts, one paragraph of thinking. Test: could another analyst retrace your steps from this page alone?

ALERT ID

CLD-0108

SOURCE SYSTEM

Identity monitoring (Entra ID)

ALERT TIME (UTC)

1 Sep 08:17 UTC

ANALYST**ALERT (WHAT FIRED, ON WHOM OR WHAT)**

CLD-0108 detected a successful sign-in for gwen.muir@cloudora.io at 03:54 UTC from 198.18.163.41 in London using IMAP4, Windows 10, and Firefox. No failed authentication attempts preceded the successful sign-in.

HYPOTHESIS (BOTH DIRECTIONS)

Account compromise using stolen credentials versus a legitimate sign-in from a new device or unfamiliar email client.

EVIDENCE CHECKED (NAME THE ACTUAL SOURCES AND WHAT EACH SHOWED)

The Cloudora sign-in evidence was compared against Gwen's normal activity baseline. Gwen normally uses macOS, Safari, business-hour access, and Microsoft 365 web applications. The suspicious event occurred at 03:54 UTC from a residential IP and used Windows 10, Firefox, and IMAP4. No failed authentication attempts preceded the successful sign-in.

VERDICT (TICK ONE)

☒ True positive ☐ False positive ☐ Duplicate ☐ Escalate ☐ Insufficient data

SEVERITY YOU ASSIGNED (TICK ONE)

☐ Sev 1 ☒ Sev 2 ☐ Sev 3 ☐ Sev 4 ☐ Informational

REPORTED SEVERITY, AND WHY RE-RATED

Reported severity was Low. Re-rated to Sev 2 because the sign-in was successful and multiple properties deviated significantly from the user's established baseline, including time, OS, browser, client application, and network. The use of legacy IMAP4 with failed attempts indicates use of already-compromised credentials.

ACTION (CLOSE / MONITOR UNTIL / ESCALATE TO / GATHER WHAT)

Reset Gwen's password, revoke active sessions, notify the user, and investigate the account for suspicious mailbox rules, forwarding rules, mailbox access, and SharePoint activity. Open an incident to investigate potential credential compromise and review the use of legacy authentication protocols such as IMAP4.

JUSTIFICATION (THE SENTENCE THAT MAKES IT DEFENSIBLE)

The successful sign-in differs significantly from Gwen's established behavior across multiple attributes. The unusual access time, Windows 10 device, Firefox browser, residential IP, and first-time use of IMAP4 collectively indicate probable account compromise rather than normal user activity. The absence of failed attempts before the successful login further suggests the credentials may already have been compromised.

MITRE ATT&CK (TRUE POSITIVES AND ESCALATIONS ONLY; A FALSE POSITIVE GETS NO TECHNIQUE)

T1078.004 — Valid Accounts: Cloud Accounts

Triage Verdict

Seven parts, one paragraph of thinking. Test: could another analyst retrace your steps from this page alone?

ALERT ID

CLD-0109

SOURCE SYSTEM

Perimeter firewall / IDS

ALERT TIME (UTC)

1 Sep 08:22 UTC

ANALYST**ALERT (WHAT FIRED, ON WHOM OR WHAT)**

CLD-0109 detected periodic outbound connections from LDN-WS-104, MAN-LT-033, and AUS-WS-208 to the same external destination, 198.18.207.66, at approximately 60-second intervals.

HYPOTHESIS (BOTH DIRECTIONS)

Coordinated malware command-and-control beaconing across multiple hosts versus legitimate but undocumented software agent or update-service communication.

EVIDENCE CHECKED (NAME THE ACTUAL SOURCES AND WHAT EACH SHOWED)

Network evidence showed three hosts across different office locations repeatedly connecting to the same rare external destination at approximately 60-second intervals. The destination/domain was relatively new, and no approved change record or documented deployment explained the activity. Identity checks for associated users did not reveal obvious suspicious sign-in activity.

VERDICT (TICK ONE)

☐ True positive ☐ False positive ☐ Duplicate ☒ Escalate ☐ Insufficient data

SEVERITY YOU ASSIGNED (TICK ONE)

☐ Sev 1 ☒ Sev 2 ☐ Sev 3 ☐ Sev 4 ☐ Informational

REPORTED SEVERITY, AND WHY RE-RATED

Reported severity was Medium. Re-rated to Sev 2 Interim because the activity affects multiple hosts across multiple locations and demonstrates a coordinated periodic beaconing pattern consistent with potential command-and-control communication. Additional investigation is required to determine the root cause and scope.

ACTION (CLOSE / MONITOR UNTIL / ESCALATE TO / GATHER WHAT)

Immediately escalate to the vCISO or Incident Response team with the affected host list, destination, timing pattern, and available evidence. Request endpoint forensic investigation and network traffic capture to determine whether the activity represents malware command-and-control communication. Do not independently isolate all affected systems until containment decisions are coordinated.

JUSTIFICATION (THE SENTENCE THAT MAKES IT DEFENSIBLE)

The repeated connections from multiple hosts across different locations to the same rare destination at regular 60-second intervals strongly resemble coordinated command-and-control beaconing. However, the available triage evidence does not conclusively prove malware, and the multi-host scope requires coordinated incident response and deeper forensic investigation.

MITRE ATT&CK (TRUE POSITIVES AND ESCALATIONS ONLY; A FALSE POSITIVE GETS NO TECHNIQUE)

Suspected T1071.001 - Application Layer Protocol: Web Protocols

Triage Verdict

Seven parts, one paragraph of thinking. Test: could another analyst retrace your steps from this page alone?

ALERT ID

CLD-0110

SOURCE SYSTEM

Identity monitoring (Conditional Access)

ALERT TIME (UTC)

1 Sep 08:26 UTC

ANALYST**ALERT (WHAT FIRED, ON WHOM OR WHAT)**

CLD-0110 detected three sign-in attempts against daniel.reeve from 102.89.44.17, an IP address previously identified as known malicious infrastructure. All attempts returned result code 53003 and were blocked by Conditional Access.

HYPOTHESIS (BOTH DIRECTIONS)

Malicious authentication attempts from known attacker infrastructure versus benign authentication activity from a misclassified source IP.

EVIDENCE CHECKED (NAME THE ACTUAL SOURCES AND WHAT EACH SHOWED)

The shift handover and previous incident context identified 102.89.44.17 as known malicious infrastructure. Sign-in evidence showed three attempts targeting daniel.reeve, with each attempt returning result code 53003, confirming that Conditional Access blocked the authentication attempts before successful access occurred.

VERDICT (TICK ONE)

☒ True positive ☐ False positive ☐ Duplicate ☐ Escalate ☐ Insufficient data

SEVERITY YOU ASSIGNED (TICK ONE)

☐ Sev 1 ☐ Sev 2 ☐ Sev 3 ☒ Sev 4 ☐ Informational

REPORTED SEVERITY, AND WHY RE-RATED

The activity was confirmed as malicious because the source IP is known attacker infrastructure. However, severity was assessed as Low because all authentication attempts were successfully blocked by Conditional Access, with no successful sign-in or confirmed account impact.

ACTION (CLOSE / MONITOR UNTIL / ESCALATE TO / GATHER WHAT)

Monitor daniel.reeve's account and document the infrastructure reuse in the related incident. Verify that Conditional Access and existing blocks remain effective. Re-escalate immediately if an attempt from 102.89.0.0/16 results in anything other than 53003 or if the activity expands to additional accounts.

JUSTIFICATION (THE SENTENCE THAT MAKES IT DEFENSIBLE)

The source IP is confirmed malicious, making this a True Positive. However, all authentication attempts were blocked before access was granted. Since there is no evidence of successful authentication or account compromise, the confirmed impact is low.

MITRE ATT&CK (TRUE POSITIVES AND ESCALATIONS ONLY; A FALSE POSITIVE GETS NO TECHNIQUE)

T1110.003 - Password Spraying (Attempted)

Triage Verdict

Seven parts, one paragraph of thinking. Test: could another analyst retrace your steps from this page alone?

ALERT ID

CLD-0111

SOURCE SYSTEM

User-reported email (soc@cloudora.io)

ALERT TIME (UTC)

1 Sep 08:31 UTC

ANALYST**ALERT (WHAT FIRED, ON WHOM OR WHAT)**

CLD-0111 involved an invoice reminder email titled "Overdue invoice INV-2214" sent to lucas.ford in Accounts Payable from billing@meridianoffice.example. The message contained a PDF attachment.

HYPOTHESIS (BOTH DIRECTIONS)

A malicious invoice-themed phishing email containing a weaponized attachment versus a legitimate overdue invoice reminder from an authorized supplier.

EVIDENCE CHECKED (NAME THE ACTUAL SOURCES AND WHAT EACH SHOWED)

Email authentication showed SPF passing, while DKIM and DMARC were not present. The From, Return-Path, and Reply-To addresses aligned, and the invoice content appeared plausible with no obvious credential phishing link. However, the available evidence did not confirm whether Meridian Office Supplies is a legitimate vendor, whether invoice INV-2214 exists, or whether the PDF attachment is malicious.

VERDICT (TICK ONE)

☐ True positive ☐ False positive ☐ Duplicate ☐ Escalate ☒ Insufficient data

SEVERITY YOU ASSIGNED (TICK ONE)

☐ Sev 1 ☐ Sev 2 ☐ Sev 3 ☐ Sev 4 ☒ Informational

REPORTED SEVERITY, AND WHY RE-RATED

The available evidence indicates a potentially suspicious invoice-themed email targeting an Accounts Payable user, but there is insufficient evidence to confirm malicious activity or legitimate business correspondence. The alert remains Medium while additional evidence is collected

ACTION (CLOSE / MONITOR UNTIL / ESCALATE TO / GATHER WHAT)

Place the investigation on hold while gathering additional evidence. Confirm with Finance/AP whether Meridian Office Supplies is an approved vendor and whether invoice INV-2214 exists. Submit the PDF attachment to an approved sandbox, perform an email message trace to identify additional recipients, and confirm whether lucas.ford opened the attachment. Escalate immediately if the attachment is malicious or if multiple Finance/AP users are targeted.

JUSTIFICATION (THE SENTENCE THAT MAKES IT DEFENSIBLE)

The available evidence supports both benign and malicious explanations. SPF and address alignment provide some legitimacy indicators, but the lack of attachment analysis and vendor verification prevents a confident classification. Additional evidence is required before determining whether the email is phishing or legitimate.

MITRE ATT&CK (TRUE POSITIVES AND ESCALATIONS ONLY; A FALSE POSITIVE GETS NO TECHNIQUE)

Triage Verdict

Seven parts, one paragraph of thinking. Test: could another analyst retrace your steps from this page alone?

ALERT ID

CLD-0112

SOURCE SYSTEM

Identity monitoring (Entra ID)

ALERT TIME (UTC)

1 Sep 08:44 UTC

ANALYST**ALERT (WHAT FIRED, ON WHOM OR WHAT)**

CLD-0112 detected an impossible travel pattern for omar.farah, with authentication activity from Dubai at 05:58 UTC and London at 06:40 UTC, approximately 42 minutes apart.

HYPOTHESIS (BOTH DIRECTIONS)

Account compromise involving authentication activity from geographically distant locations versus legitimate travel combined with a non-interactive token refresh from a stationary corporate device

EVIDENCE CHECKED (NAME THE ACTUAL SOURCES AND WHAT EACH SHOWED)

Sign-in activity showed Omar using his registered iPhone in Dubai at 05:58 UTC and again later in Dubai. The conflicting London event at 06:40 UTC originated from a Windows 11 device using Microsoft Teams and was identified as a successful non-interactive token refresh. The event did not represent Omar physically logging in from London.

VERDICT (TICK ONE)

☐ True positive ☒ False positive ☐ Duplicate ☐ Escalate ☐ Insufficient data

SEVERITY YOU ASSIGNED (TICK ONE)

☐ Sev 1 ☐ Sev 2 ☐ Sev 3 ☐ Sev 4 ☒ Informational

REPORTED SEVERITY, AND WHY RE-RATED

Reported severity was Medium. Re-rated to Informational because the apparent impossible travel was explained by legitimate user travel to Dubai while a stationary corporate device in London performed a non-interactive Microsoft Teams token refresh.

ACTION (CLOSE / MONITOR UNTIL / ESCALATE TO / GATHER WHAT)

Close the alert as a False Positive and document the legitimate travel and non-interactive token refresh explanation. Recommend tuning impossible-travel detection to account for non-interactive authentication events and reduce false positives.

JUSTIFICATION (THE SENTENCE THAT MAKES IT DEFENSIBLE)

Although the geographic locations appeared impossible within the observed timeframe, the sign-in event types and device context explained the activity. Omar's Dubai activity originated from his registered iPhone, while the London event was a non-interactive token refresh from an existing corporate device session. No evidence of unauthorized account access was identified.

MITRE ATT&CK (TRUE POSITIVES AND ESCALATIONS ONLY; A FALSE POSITIVE GETS NO TECHNIQUE)